Youth Digital Literacy & Online Language Guide for Schools, Public Libraries & Parents

Distinguishing Harmless Group-Chat Hyperbole from Algospeak and Online Subculture Jargon (100% SFW, CC BY 4.0)

Primary CERN Zenodo Corpus DOI (10.5281/zenodo.23541347): https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.235413

CERN Zenodo ESL Curriculum DOI (10.5281/zenodo.23541449): https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.235414

All SlangLane Academic Working Papers & PDFs: https://slanglane.com/papers

Interactive ESL Teacher Kit & Quiz Maker: https://slanglane.com/esl

Abstract & Scope

Prepared for K-12 educators, school counselors, public librarians, and parent-teacher associations. Explains how teenagers and young adults use hyperbolic slang (cooked, delulu, ate, crash out), platform-evasion wording (algospeak), and online subculture vocabulary (brain rot, parasocial, looksmaxxing, mewing) so adults can assess context accurately without moral panic.

Interactive Companion Tools on SlangLane.com

Slang Age & Brain-Rot Diagnostic Lab: https://slanglane.com/vibe-check

Corporate Email <-> Gen Z Group-Chat Translator: https://slanglane.com/roast

Court & HR Legal Exhibit Stamp Generator: https://slanglane.com/exhibit

5x5 Classroom & Meeting Slang Bingo: https://slanglane.com/bingo

Side-by-Side Usage Comparisons (A vs. B): https://slanglane.com/compare

Indexed Thematic Entries (79 Headwords, Edition daily-2026-10-21)

1. AFK - [Gaming | informal]

In plain English, "AFK": away from keyboard. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/afk

2. AI slop (aliases: slop, AI-generated slop) - [Digital culture | Critical derogatory]

Low-quality AI-generated material, especially output produced in volume with little concern for accuracy, coherence, or usefulness. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/ai-slop

3. algospeak (aliases: algo-speak, algorithm speak) - [Digital culture | Platform culture descriptive]

Altered words, spellings, euphemisms, or symbols people use because they believe platform algorithms may restrict the original wording. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/algospeak

4. ate (aliases: ate that, ate and left no crumbs, left no crumbs) - [Internet essentials | Enthusiastic praise]

Performed brilliantly, looked excellent, or completely delivered. "Ate and left no crumbs" intensifies the compliment. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/ate

5. aura (aliases: aura points, aura loss, negative aura) - [Internet essentials | Playful evaluative]

An impression of coolness, confidence, or striking presence. "Aura points" turn that impression into a joking, imaginary score. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/aura

6. aura farming (aliases: aura farm, aura farmer) - [Internet essentials | Admiring or teasing]

Cultivating an effortlessly cool image through a pose, gesture, performance, or carefully timed moment. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/aura-farming

7. banter (aliases: bants, bantering) - [Across the Atlantic | Playful relationship-dependent]

Playful, quick back-and-forth conversation, often involving teasing that the participants enjoy. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/banter

8. based - [Internet essentials | informal]

based: praiseworthy despite being unpopular or controversial. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/based

9. bet (aliases: aight bet) - [Internet essentials | Casual affirmative]

"Okay," "agreed," "sounds good," or "challenge accepted." The tone depends on what the speaker is responding to. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/bet

10. brain rot (aliases: brainrot, brain-rotted, brain rot content) - [Internet essentials | Critical or self-mocking]

Low-value, repetitive online content, or the feeling of being mentally saturated by it. Also a joking name for an intense fandom obsession. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/brain-rot

11. canon event (aliases: canon events) - [Social & memes | Storytelling metaphor often ironic]

A formative experience jokingly treated as an unavoidable part of someone's personal storyline, often embarrassing or difficult. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/canon-event

12. Chad - [Internet essentials | Admiring, ironic or status-focused]

An internet archetype of a highly attractive, sexually successful man; in a meme, the label can express exaggerated admiration or contrast. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/chad

13. cheers - [Across the Atlantic | Friendly informal]

A toast when drinking; also informal "thanks" or a friendly sign-off, especially in British and Irish English. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/cheers

14. chronically online (aliases: terminally online, extremely online) - [Digital culture | Critical or self-mocking]

So immersed in internet culture or disputes that your references, assumptions, or priorities seem disconnected from ordinary offline experience. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/chronically-online

15. chuffed (aliases: well chuffed, chuffed to bits) - [Across the Atlantic | Informal pleased]

Very pleased, proud, or delighted about something. "Chuffed to bits" is an especially enthusiastic version. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/chuffed

16. clickbait (aliases: click bait, click-bait) - [Social & memes | Critical publishing language]

A headline, thumbnail, or piece of content built to win clicks, often by withholding the point, exaggerating, or misleading. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/clickbait

17. cooked (aliases: we are cooked, i'm cooked, am I cooked) - [Internet essentials | Dramatic usually negative]

In serious trouble, exhausted, defeated, or beyond an easy fix. "Am I cooked?" asks whether the situation is hopeless. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/cooked

18. craic (aliases: the craic, what's the craic, good craic) - [Across the Atlantic | Informal social]

Enjoyable company, conversation, fun, or news. "What's the craic?" can mean "what's happening?" or "how are things?" | Regions: IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/craic

19. crash out - [Internet essentials | Anger-related slang / ambiguous]

To lose control in anger or act recklessly with serious consequences; separately, to fall asleep from exhaustion, fail or be eliminated. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/crash-out

20. cringe - [Internet essentials | context-dependent]

cringe: feel embarrassed, disgusted, or fearful. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/cringe

21. cringey - [Internet essentials | context-dependent]

In plain English, "cringey": embarrassing. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/cringey

22. dead internet theory (aliases: dead Internet theory) - [Digital culture | Theory / meme not established fact]

The idea that much online activity is automated or artificial rather than human; stronger versions make unsupported claims that most of the internet is fake. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/dead-internet-theory

23. delulu (aliases: delulu is the solulu) - [Internet essentials | Playful can be dismissive]

An exaggerated, informal version of "delusional": unrealistically hopeful, imagining a connection, or choosing confidence over the available evidence. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/delulu

24. doomscrolling (aliases: doomscroll, doom scrolling, doom-scrolling, doomscrolls) - [Social & memes | Informal digital habits]

Continuing to scroll through distressing news or negative posts, often longer than you intended. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/doomscrolling

25. eejit - [Across the Atlantic | pejorative]

A pejorative regional word for an idiot or fool, documented for Ireland and Scotland. | Regions: IE, UK | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/eejit

26. FR (aliases: fr, frfr, for real, for real for real) - [Texting shorthand | Casual sincere or questioning]

"For real": an emphasis on sincerity, a strong agreement, or a surprised question meaning "seriously?" | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/fr

27. FWIW - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "FWIW": for what it's worth. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/fwiw

28. GG - [Gaming | informal]

In plain English, "GG": good game. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/gg

29. ghosting (aliases: ghosted, ghost someone) - [People & relationships | Informal relationships and contact]

Ending or abandoning an ongoing connection by stopping communication without an explanation. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/ghosting

30. glazing (aliases: glaze) - [Internet essentials | Disapproving or self-mocking praise label]

Giving someone or something excessive praise; the label suggests the admiration is over the top, unwarranted or annoying. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/glazing

31. goated - [Internet essentials | informal praise]

A slang description for someone or something considered the greatest of all time or the best. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/goated

32. gobsmacked - [Across the Atlantic | informal]

gobsmacked: utterly astonished and speechless. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/gobsmacked

33. grand (aliases: that is grand, that's grand, I'm grand) - [Across the Atlantic | Informal reassuring]

In Irish English, often "fine," "okay," or "no problem." It does not necessarily mean magnificent or unusually impressive. | Regions: IE, UK | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/grand

34. green flag (aliases: green flags, greenflag) - [People & relationships | Approving reassuring]

An encouraging sign that someone or something may be trustworthy, compatible, or worth pursuing. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/green-flag

35. gutted - [Across the Atlantic | Informal deeply disappointed]

Very disappointed, upset, or crushed by an unwelcome result. Often used for a loss, cancellation, or missed opportunity. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/gutted

36. highkey (aliases: high-key, high key, highk) - [Internet essentials | Emphatic openly stated]

"Really," "openly," or "without trying to play it down." It turns an opinion or feeling into a more direct declaration. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/highkey

37. ick (aliases: the ick) - [People & relationships | Informal aversion]

A feeling or expression of disgust or aversion. "The ick" can describe a reaction that makes someone suddenly feel put off. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/ick

38. ICYMI - [Texting shorthand | internet slang]

ICYMI expands to 'in case you missed it,' introducing information for a reader who may have missed it. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/icymi

39. IDK - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "IDK": I don't know. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/idk

40. IMO - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "IMO": in my opinion. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/imo

41. IYKYK (aliases: if you know you know, iykyk) - [Texting shorthand | Knowing inside reference]

"If you know, you know": a signal that people with the shared experience or background will understand an unstated reference. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/iykyk

42. locked in (aliases: lock in, locking in, locked-in) - [Internet essentials | Focused motivational]

Fully focused and committed to a task. "Time to lock in" means it is time to stop distractions and concentrate. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/locked-in

43. looksmaxxing - [Internet essentials | Appearance-focused community vocabulary]

Trying to improve physical appearance, especially within online communities that frame attractiveness as a competitive status or dating advantage. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/looksmaxxing

44. lore (aliases: lore drop, personal lore) - [Social & memes | Storytelling often playful]

The background story and accumulated details of a fictional world, community, or person. A "lore drop" reveals a new piece of that backstory. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/lore

45. love bombing - [People & relationships | context-dependent]

love bombing: manipulative over affection tactic. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/love-bombing

46. lowkey (aliases: low-key, low key, lowk, lwk) - [Internet essentials | Understated informal]

"Kind of," "quietly," or "I am admitting this without making a big deal of it." A low-key event is also relaxed or understated. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/lowkey

47. main character energy (aliases: main-character energy) - [Social & memes | Admiring or critical]

A confident, cinematic sense of being the protagonist of the moment; sometimes a criticism of acting as if everyone else is a supporting character. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/main-character-energy

48. mate (aliases: mates) - [Across the Atlantic | Familiar tone-sensitive]

A friend or a familiar way to address someone. It can sound warm, neutral, sarcastic, or confrontational depending on delivery. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/mate

49. mewing - [Internet essentials | Appearance-trend vocabulary / ambiguous]

A tongue-posture practice pursued with the aim of changing jaw or facial appearance; also the ordinary act of making a mew sound. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/mewing

50. mid - [Internet essentials | Dismissive evaluative]

Mediocre, underwhelming, or not worth the hype. Usually a criticism, even though it literally suggests the middle. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/mid

51. mogging - [Internet essentials | Comparative / appearance-ranking slang]

Outshining or appearing superior to someone, especially in perceived physical attractiveness; a subjective comparison rather than an objective score. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/mogging

52. no cap (aliases: nocap, no capping) - [Internet essentials | Informal emphatic]

"Honestly," "for real," or "I am not exaggerating." Cap means a lie or an exaggeration in this slang context. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/no-cap

53. OMW - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "OMW": on my way. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/omw

54. pookie - [People & relationships | Affectionate, cutesy or playful]

An affectionate name for a loved person, such as a partner, friend or relative; as an address, roughly sweetheart or darling. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/pookie

55. POV (aliases: point of view, pov) - [Texting shorthand | Perspective scenario framing]

"Point of view." In captions, it usually introduces a situation the viewer is invited to imagine experiencing. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/pov

56. proper - [Across the Atlantic | colloquial]

A UK and Irish colloquial use of proper as an adverb meaning thoroughly or completely. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/proper

57. rage bait (aliases: ragebait, rage-bait, rage baiting) - [Social & memes | Critical media language]

Content designed to provoke anger so people will react, argue, share, or keep watching. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/rage-bait

58. ratio (aliases: ratioed, ratio'd, ratioing) - [Social & memes | Combative platform-dependent]

A social-media response showing stronger pushback than approval, or a reply that gets more support than the post it challenges. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/ratio

59. red flag (aliases: red flags, redflag) - [People & relationships | Warning sometimes exaggerated]

A warning sign that something may be wrong or deserves closer attention, especially in a relationship or decision. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/red-flag

60. rent-free (aliases: rent free, living rent-free, lives rent free) - [Social & memes | Teasing sometimes dismissive]

Occupying someone's thoughts without effort or invitation, usually in "living rent-free in my head." It can describe delight, annoyance, or fixation. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/rent-free

61. rizz (aliases: rizz up, rizzing, rizzed, unspoken rizz) - [Internet essentials | Playful usually flattering]

Charm or the ability to attract someone, especially through flirting. To "rizz someone up" is to try to win them over. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/rizz

62. scroll fatigue - [Digital culture | Emerging informal]

A feeling of being mentally worn out by prolonged scrolling through feeds or other online material. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/scroll-fatigue

63. side quest (aliases: sidequest, side quests) - [Social & memes | Playful gaming metaphor]

An optional detour from the main objective in a game, or a spontaneous little adventure away from your original plan in everyday life. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/side-quest

64. sigma - [Internet essentials | Ironic or status-focused internet language]

A self-sufficient lone-wolf male archetype; also praise meaning excellent, or a deliberately absurd word in memes such as "what the sigma." | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/sigma

65. simp - [Internet essentials | Derogatory or self-mocking]

Someone accused of excessive devotion or deference to another person; as a verb, to admire or praise in an exaggerated, deferential way. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/simp

66. situationship (aliases: situationships) - [People & relationships | Informal dating language]

A romantic connection whose status, expectations, or commitment have not been clearly defined. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/situationship

67. six seven (aliases: 67, 6-7, 6 7, six-seven) - [Internet essentials | Absurdist context-dependent]

A meme expression usually said "six seven," often with a balancing hand gesture. It has no single fixed literal meaning. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/six-seven

68. skibidi - [Internet essentials | Absurd meme language]

A deliberately nonsensical meme word used for humorous effect, reactions or references to internet slang; it has no single dependable plain-English meaning. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/skibidi

69. slay (aliases: slayed, slaying) - [Internet essentials | Enthusiastic approving]

To do something impressively well or look excellent. "Slay!" is an enthusiastic expression of approval. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/slay

70. soft launch (aliases: soft-launch, soft launching, soft-launched) - [People & relationships | Social media indirect reveal]

Hinting at a romantic relationship online without clearly identifying the partner or explicitly announcing the relationship. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/soft-launch

71. sound (aliases: sound person, sound as) - [Across the Atlantic | Informal approving]

Decent, reliable, friendly, or good. As a short reply, "sound" can mean "okay," "agreed," or an appreciative acknowledgment. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/sound

72. sus (aliases: sussy) - [Internet essentials | Suspicious often joking]

Suspicious, questionable, or not quite trustworthy. It can be a genuine concern or a playful reaction to odd behavior. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/sus

73. tasteslop (aliases: taste slop) - [Digital culture | Emerging critical]

A critical label for AI-generated style or lifestyle content that appears tasteful and curated but feels generic, derivative, or empty. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/tasteslop

74. TBH - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "TBH": to be honest. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/tbh

75. TL;DR (aliases: tl;dr, TLDR, tldr, too long didnt read, too long; didn't read) - [Texting shorthand | Concise sometimes dismissive]

"Too long; didn't read." It can dismiss a long message, but is also a common label for a short summary supplied by the writer. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/tldr

76. touch grass (aliases: touching grass, touched grass, go touch grass) - [Social & memes | Teasing often dismissive]

Step away from the internet and regain some real-world perspective. Often a dismissive response to an overly online argument. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/touch-grass

77. unc - [Internet essentials | Affectionate or teasing age-related slang]

A shortening of uncle; also a teasing label for an older man or somebody seen as out of touch with current youth culture. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/unc

78. vibe coding (aliases: vibe code, vibe-coded, vibecoding) - [Digital culture | Technical culture debated scope]

Building software by repeatedly prompting an AI and reacting to the result, especially when the person pays little attention to the underlying code. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/vibe-coding

79. W (aliases: w) - [Internet essentials | internet slang]

In internet slang, W abbreviates win: a success or winning result. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/w